

SIEM Dashboard & SOC Metrics Specification

Dashboard design for analyst operations, detection health, and management reporting

Panel	Metric / visualization	Analyst value
Failed logins over time	Timechart of authentication failures	Detect spikes and compare alert timing to baseline.
Top failed-login source IPs	Bar/table by src_ip	Identify concentrated attack sources or misconfigured systems.
Top targeted usernames	Bar/table by username	Find heavily targeted or privileged identities.
Failures followed by success	Table of user/source/time sequence	Prioritize likely compromise over failure-only activity.
Distinct users per source	Count by src_ip	Surface password spraying and credential stuffing patterns.
Alert disposition	TP / BP / FP / Informational trend	Measure signal quality and tuning need.
Mean time to acknowledge	Alert -> analyst acknowledgement	Measure queue responsiveness.
Mean time to disposition	Alert -> close/escalate	Measure investigation efficiency without rewarding shallow closures.
High-severity open alerts	Count + aging	Expose operational risk and backlog.
Detection false-positive rate	FP / total alerts by rule	Identify rules requiring engineering work.

Example SPL for Dashboard Panels

Failed logins over time

index=auth action=failure | timechart span=15m count

Top source IPs

index=auth action=failure | stats count AS failures dc(username) AS users BY src_ip | sort - failures

Failures followed by success

index=auth | transaction username src_ip maxspan=10m | search action=failure action=success | table _time username src_ip duration eventcount action

Disposition trend

index=soc_cases | timechart span=1d count BY disposition

Metric Guardrails

- High alert closure volume is not automatically good performance; quality and missed risk matter.
- MTTR should be segmented by severity and detection type.
- False-positive rate should be reviewed by detection, not only as an overall percentage.
- Backlog aging is more useful than raw backlog size when prioritizing risk.
- Dashboards should support investigations, not replace evidence review.